

The Oasis

THE OASIS

A colony survival framework.



A colony ship carrying 5,000 sleeping settlers woke 400 years crushing into the world they left, which had died while they slept. Now 4,400 survivors live in a crashed ship on the edge of a post apocalyptic world, surrounded by ruins and terror.

The Setting

THE SETTING

*Cold first. Then amber light.
Emergency.*

*A face. Kebolt Hemington, Crew
Welfare. He's supposed to be the
first thing you see when you
arrive.*

*"Something went wrong with the
drive.*

*"Its... its gone. The Korenfeld
Drive is gone."*

*"We're back in Rimaer. 400 years
have passed. The world is ruined.
The ship came down hard, we
crushed back into the planet." A
pause. "Life support can't hold
everyone. Most of the colony's still
under."*

*He meets your eyes. "We're
waking people when we need
them."
"We need you."*



THE WORLD YOU LEFT

Rimaer-Prime was human civilization at its apex. Sixty two billion people.

One government — the **Pantheon**, spanning a single temperate world and three terraformed moons. Disease eliminated. Lifespans extended. Cybernetics common. A Dyson sphere under construction around the sun.

The **Korenfeld Drive** — humanity's first FTL engine, proven and ready for its first true test.

The Pantheon's plan was vast. One hundred colony ships, five thousand colonists each, sent to one hundred worlds within two hundred light-years. You were one of the five thousand aboard **The Oasis**, the first ship to launch. The test. The flagship. The one the whole civilization was watching.

WHAT HAPPENED

Something went wrong with the Korenfeld Drive.

The Oasis's records show only this: the main drive failed partway through its rewrite process. The smaller backup drive engaged automatically

and spent approximately **400 years** completing an emergency trace-back. When the ship came out of the **Medium**, it was above Rimaer Prime, the world it had left. The instruments confirmed the date. Four centuries had passed.

The communications array found no Pantheon transmissions. No civilian broadcasts. No emergency signals on any frequency the Oasis was built to receive. The orbit was decaying. By the time you woke the ship already crushed back into the planet.

TONE

Tragic science fiction. A colony of the last survivors of human civilization trying to stay alive on the ruins of everything they came from.

There is no villain to defeat. No justice to extract. Only 4,400 people who need to eat, stay warm, and figure out what happened to the world they left. And maybe, just maybe, rebuild the drive that got them here.

This framework is for players who want to care about the people around them, not just the mission. Sessions are about hard calls with no clean answers: who gets woken next, what gets rationed, which expedition is worth the risk. Characters come with histories. Those histories matter. The person in the next bunk is not a side character.

The horror is slow. It lives in what the world has become and in what people become under pressure. You will not defeat something and feel safe again. Safety is not the destination.

The Storyteller's job is not to punish the players. It is to make the stakes feel real.

INSPIRED BY

Fiction: The Thing, Annihilation, Children of time.

Video Games: Rimworld, Subnautica.

TTRPGs: Mothership.

WHAT YOU WOKE TO

The Oasis is down. It came down in a marshland at the edge of what was once a coastal metropolitan region. Most of the hull is intact. Enough of it isn't.

Life support is rationed — the ship cannot sustain 4,400 people simultaneously on its current reserves. Most colonists are still in cryosleep. People are being woken in shifts, as the colony needs them. You were woken because you were needed.

The world outside is not the Rimaer-Prime anyone aboard remembers.

- The cities are ruins, overgrown, scavenged, or still burning
- The land near the crash is anomalous in measurable ways
- There are people on the surface, survivors and their descendants
- Food and water are finite
- Power systems are degrading
- The anomalous marsh surrounds the crash site
- Surface factions are watching
- Political fractures are forming inside the colony
- Six hundred empty cryopods



TERMS & ASSUMPTIONS

KEY TERMS

The Medium — the fourth-dimensional substrate the Korenfeld Drive uses to fold space. Ships exist outside normal spacetime during transit. Duration inside the Medium does not map to duration outside it.

The Rewrite — the process of translating matter through the Medium and back. The main drive failed mid-rewrite. What that means for the ship, the colonists, and the world is still being studied.

Cryosleep — the hibernation state all 5,000 colonists were in during transit. Life support cannot sustain the full population awake simultaneously. Most are still under.

The Pantheon — the unified government of Rimaer-Prime before the collapse. Its records, laws, and scientific archive survived aboard the Oasis. The civilization itself did not.

Rimaer-Prime — the origin world. A single temperate planet that once held 62 billion people, three terraformed moons, and a Dyson sphere under construction. It collapsed while the Oasis was in the Medium. What is left is four centuries of ruins, survivors, and consequences.

The Korenfeld Drive — humanity's first faster-than-light engine, powered by the Dyson sphere under construction around Rimaer's sun. It works in two phases. First, the drive rewrites every atom of the ship and its contents into a Medium-compatible state — a process that takes days and requires enormous energy. Then the ship folds through the Medium and emerges at the destination. The transit itself is instantaneous. The rewrite is not.

The Oasis carried a main drive and a smaller backup. The main drive failed mid-rewrite and is gone. The backup completed a 400-year emergency trace-back and burned out on arrival. The knowledge to rebuild one exists in the Pantheon archive. Whether the energy and materials to do so exist on Rimaer-Prime is what the Astrogator is trying to determine.

The Directorate — the colony's governing council. Nine roles, each responsible for a critical

domain: logistics, security, medicine, research, engineering, community, navigation, and the Prime Prefect who holds legal authority over all of them.

The Remnants — the people on the surface. Survivors and their descendants, living in the ruins of Rimaer-Prime for four hundred years without a central government. Organized into settlements, factions, and cults. Not all of them are hostile. Probably...

Anomalous Zones — area site where physical measurements behave incorrectly. Instruments give inconsistent readings. Objects and organisms that enter do not always return unchanged.

IDEAS & ASSUMPTIONS

The ship is the colony. Until it is repaired, reinforced, or replaced, the Oasis is civilization. Leaving it without a plan is not heroism. It is subtraction from a finite resource.

Technology works. The Pantheon archive is intact. Fabricators are running. Medicine is functional at reduced capacity. This is not a primitive survival story — it is a resource management story with advanced tools that are slowly running out.

You want to survive, or get off the planet. The Oasis is not a ship. It is a colony. It is a home. It is a way to rebuild the drive that got you here. It is not a shipwreck. It is not a dead world. It is not a prison. It is not a graveyard. It is a home.

The surface is hostile. People live out there. They have for four centuries. The players can go outside, trade, fight, explore. The anomalous zones are the hard boundary, not the surface itself.

No one knows what happened. The drive failed. That is all the records say. Players and Storyteller should treat the cause as an open question until the story reveals it.

The Colony

THE COLONY

The Oasis is the colony. Until it is repaired, reinforced, or abandoned, every system aboard is a survival question. The ship’s reactors are holding. The fabricators can produce most essential equipment. The armory is intact. The Pantheon archive has every scientific record.

WHAT YOU HAVE

- 4,400 colonists, specialists in everything
- Fabricators (partially damaged)
- Seed banks and hydroponic bays (damaged)
- Full Pantheon scientific and cultural archive
- Medical facility at reduced capacity
- Armory and trained marines
- Backup Korenfeld Drive, inert, not operational

WHAT YOU DON'T HAVE

- A way off the planet
- Contact with the Pantheon
- Allies on the surface
- Answers

THE DRIVE

The backup drive is inert — it completed its 400-year emergency trace-back and burned out. The Pantheon physics archive is intact. The knowledge to rebuild a Korenfeld Drive may exist in those records. Whether the materials, the energy, and the time to do so exist on Rimaer-Prime is a different question. The Astrogator is working on it.

THE DIRECTORATE

The Oasis was built to govern a peaceful colony on a friendly world. It is now governing a crash survival operation on a hostile post-apocalyptic one.

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
Prime Prefect	Colony authority
Chief of Logistics	Food, energy, resources; second in command
Chief Security	Marines and internal security
Biometric Director	Medicine, surgery, and genetics
Archive Director	Research, science, and databases
Core Director	Engineering and construction
Community Director	Morale, psychology, and culture

Astrogator
Korenfeld physics; rebuilding the drive



THE DIRECTORATE

Eight people hold authority over 4,400 lives. They were selected before launch for their expertise and their records. They were not selected for this situation. Most of them are adapting. Some are not.

KEY FIGURES

Prime Prefect — Maren Solvi

Holds the Pantheon legal charter and final authority over all colony decisions. A career administrator from Rimaer’s civil governance. She spent twenty years managing planetary infrastructure projects. She has never managed a disaster. She is learning.

Chief of Logistics — Edric Vanta

Second in command. Controls food, water, power allocation, and fabricator output. Every rationing decision flows through him. The most informed person on the ship about how close things actually are.

Chief Security — Sable Korr

Commands the marine contingent and internal security. Pre-launch military background with Pantheon border enforcement. Pragmatic. Does not use more force than needed. Has not yet determined how much force is needed.

Biometric Director — Priya Adaeze

Responsible for medicine, surgery, and the long-term genetic health of the population. Running a reduced-capacity medical bay for 4,400 people with supplies built for a colony with resupply routes. No resupply routes exist.

Archive Director — Yusuf Osei

Research, science, and the Pantheon archive. The most knowledgeable living person on Rimaer about what this world was four centuries ago. That knowledge does not tell him what it is now.

Core Director — Tomas Brech

Engineering and construction. Keeping the hull together, the reactors running, and the fabricators operational. Has a list of critical repairs. The list is longer than the time available.

Community Director — Linh Arvan

Morale, psychology, and internal culture. The least visible Directorate role and the one that will matter most in twelve months. People who have lost everything they knew and cannot go back need somewhere to put that.

Astrogator — Dav Kellner

The only Korenfeld physicist on the ship.

Responsible for rebuilding the drive if it can be rebuilt. Working from archive theory and salvaged hardware. Has not reported a timeline. Has not been asked for one.

COLONY STATISTICS

DEPARTMENT	PERSONNEL
Security (marines + internal)	200
Medical staff	150
Engineering corps	280
Agricultural team	180
Research division	120
Logistics and administration	160
Community and psychology	90
Korenfeld physics	15
Support and general roles	3,205
Total	4,400

THE SURFACE

Four hundred years is enough time for a civilization to collapse, leave ruins, and have something else grow in the gap. What grew in the gap on Rimaer-Prime is still being mapped. What it means for the Oasis is still being determined.

THE MARSH

The crash site sits at the edge of a vast marshland that did not exist on any maps the Oasis carried. Something created it over the past four centuries — broken infrastructure, altered hydrology, and anomalous zones centered around certain sites across the planet.

The marsh is not uniformly dangerous. Large sections can be traversed with care. Others cannot — not because of anything visible, but because things that enter them do not reliably come back, or come back wrong.

ANOMALOUS ZONES

Scattered through the marsh and into the ruins are regions where matter behaves outside normal parameters. Your scientists can measure the effects. The measurements don't yet explain them.

The zones are not random. They cluster around certain sites — old places, geographically significant locations. The surface survivors treat these sites with reverence, fear, or both. The Oasis archive has no record of what those sites were before the collapse.

WHAT THE ZONES DO

Matter composition shifts under prolonged exposure. Cellular tissue transforms in patterns that don't match any known disease or mutation process. Objects placed in certain zones are recovered in altered states. The alterations have internal structure. That structure does not match any known physical process.



Character Creation

CHARACTER CREATION

You are an Oasis colonist who just woke from cryosleep. You had a career, a role, and a life on Rimaer-Prime before you boarded. All of that is 400 years gone — but it shaped who you are, what you can do, and what is already cracked inside you waiting to open under pressure.

- 1 Choose **2 Proficiencies** from the crew manifest — the careers and competencies that define what you are trained to do.
Choose **2 Specialties** — one narrow focus under each Proficiency. Each contributes +2 when it clearly applies.
- 2 Choose **2 Traits** — permanent personality features that define how you act under pressure. They can become Burdens when the fiction demands it.
- 3 Receive your **Pantheon Standard Kit**.
- 4 Assume any tools appropriate to your proficiencies are in your personal kit.
Define **1 relationship** with another colonist — someone you knew before cryo, or someone you have connected with since waking. Name them. Say what it is.
- 5 Choose **1 Play** — a narrative tool that gives you permission to do something creative, dramatic, or unexpected.
- 6

IF YOU'D HAVE IT

Colonists don't inventory every item. If something fits your proficiency and your life aboard the Oasis, you have it. If it's rare, dangerous, or colony-critical — ask the Storyteller.

OPENING QUESTIONS

Answer these together before play begins. They are not backstory — they are the beginning of the story.

AS A GROUP

Which of you knew each other before boarding?

What were you doing on Rimaer-Prime in the weeks before launch?

What was the first thing each of you saw when your pod opened?

Which of the 600 empty pods did you walk past first?

PANTHEON STANDARD KIT

Every colonist receives:

- Sealed work coverall
- Personal tablet (Pantheon database access)
- Standard ration pack (3 days)
- Water canteen and flashlight
- Pantheon ID and subdermal comm implant

PROFICIENCIES

Choose **2 proficiencies** from the crew manifest below. These are the roles you held aboard the Oasis — what you trained for, what you were hired for, what you know. You may create your own with Storyteller approval.

CATEGORY	ROLE
Engineering	Zero-G Shipbreaker
Engineering	Heavy Machinery Operator
Engineering	Structural Engineer
Engineering	Reactor / Power Systems Tech
Engineering	Cybernetics Technician
Engineering	Sanitation / Recycler
Science	Planetologist
Science	Xenobiologist / Pathologist
Science	Hydroponics Agronomist
Science	Astrogator / Drive Specialist
Science	Deep-Space Archaeologist
Science	Sophontologist
Medical	Trauma Surgeon
Medical	Pharmacologist / Chemist
Medical	Cryo-Stasis Technician
Medical	Colony Psychologist
Medical	Ration Quartermaster / Cook
Medical	Geneticist

CATEGORY	ROLE
Security	Pantheon Marine
Security	Close-Quarters Breacher
Security	Brig Warden / Corrections Officer
Security	Artillery / Explosives Tech
Security	Internal Security Operative
Administration	Pantheon Magistrate / Diplomat
Administration	Ideologue / Moral Guide
Administration	Oasis Archivist
Administration	Colony Entertainer
Administration	Propagandist

SPECIALTY EXAMPLES

PROFICIENCY	SPECIALTY
Trauma Surgeon	Field amputation under fire
Trauma Surgeon	Cryopod revival complications
Pharmacologist	Improvised sedative synthesis
Pharmacologist	Anomalous tissue analysis
Cryo-Stasis Technician	Emergency mid-sleep revival
Cryo-Stasis Technician	Pod failure forensics
Colony Psychologist	Post-trauma stabilization
Colony Psychologist	Cult deprogramming
Geneticist	Population viability modeling
Structural Engineer	Crash damage triage
Structural Engineer	Marsh terrain anchoring
Reactor Tech	Emergency power rerouting
Reactor Tech	Fuel cell improvisation
Cybernetics Technician	Field implant repair
Cybernetics Technician	Subdermal comm extraction
Zero-G Shipbreaker	Hull breach emergency patch
Heavy Machinery Operator	Salvage extraction from ruins
Sanitation / Recycler	Water purification from marsh

PROFICIENCY	SPECIALTY
Planetologist	Anomalous zone mapping
Planetologist	Soil and atmosphere analysis
Xenobiologist	Marsh fauna threat assessment
Xenobiologist	Contamination identification
Hydroponics Agronomist	Rapid crop cycle design
Hydroponics Agronomist	Soil substitute cultivation
Astrogator	Korenfeld drive diagnostics
Astrogator	Medium exposure aftermath
Deep-Space Archaeologist	Pre-collapse site excavation
Sophontologist	Surface dialect interpretation
Sophontologist	Cult belief system analysis
Pantheon Marine	Hostile terrain patrol
Pantheon Marine	Breach and clear operations
Close-Quarters Breacher	Ship interior combat
Artillery Tech	Controlled demolition
Internal Security	Informant network management
Pantheon Magistrate	Colonial law under crisis
Oasis Archivist	Pre-collapse history recovery

PLAYS

Choose **1 Play** at character creation. Plays are not bonuses — they are **permissions** to do something creative, dramatic, or unexpected. Per-scene plays reset each scene. Per-session plays reset each session.

WHEN	PLAY	EFFECT
Scene	Read Between the Lines	Study a person, document, or scene. Ask the Storyteller one honest question.
Scene	Ghost Move	Retroactively declare you moved to a different position before this moment.
Scene	Desperate Improvisation	Solve a problem using only what's in the scene. Creative enough? It works — Storyteller names the cost.
Scene	Jury-Rig the Scene	Establish one detail about the current location that hasn't been mentioned yet.
Scene	Make a Scene	Draw every eye to yourself for one beat. You choose what happens in that window.
Scene	Brace for Impact	Danger hits, but you choose how it lands — and you're still standing.
Scene	Echo	When someone else fails, turn their bad moment into your opening.
Scene	Confessional	Reveal something true and hidden. Vulnerability becomes leverage.
Scene	Walk the Zone	Navigate an anomalous area without triggering exposure. You can't explain how. You just knew.
Scene	Hold the Line	Declare you are not moving. Nothing passes you this scene without going through you first.
Scene	Two Steps Ahead	Declare you anticipated this. Name one thing you already prepared before the scene started.
Scene	Read the Room	Ask the Storyteller: what does this group want, fear, and not say out loud?
Scene	First One In	You go first. Declare the opening move before anyone else can act. It happens, cleanly.
Scene	Controlled Burn	Destroy something contained to stop something worse. You choose what is lost.
Scene	Signal Noise	Introduce interference — physical, social, or electronic. One action this scene fails to land.
Session	I Know a Guy	Declare you know someone relevant. Describe the connection. They exist now.
Session	Invoke the Past	Introduce a fact, preparation, or connection from before cryo. The fiction adjusts.
Session	Plan B	When a plan falls apart, reveal the backup you prepared — Storyteller says what's missing.
Session	Sacrifice Play	Destroy or give up something that matters to guarantee one specific outcome.
Session	Dead Man's Gambit	Do something reckless and unexpected. Genuinely creative? Complications don't apply.
Session	Colony First	Endanger yourself to protect a critical colony resource. If you survive, the colony gains something.
Session	From the Archive	Cite specific Pantheon knowledge from the ship's database. It changes how the situation can be approached.
Session	Not Today	Once per session, a consequence that would take you out instead leaves you standing — barely.
Session	Long Memory	You remember something about this place, person, or system from before the crash. It matters now.
Session	The Hard Call	Make a decision no one else will make. The fiction moves forward. The cost is yours alone.
Session	Wake Someone Up	Request a specific sleeper be revived. They arrive next scene. The colony loses a cryopod slot.

TRAITS

Traits define how your character acts under pressure. They are permanent personality anchors — and can become the basis for a Burden when the fiction demands it.

Psychological

TRAIT	DESCRIPTION
Volatile	Quick to anger, panic, or despair under pressure
Pessimist	Dwells on inevitable doom even in moments of victory
Optimist	Stays hopeful even when circumstances appear hopeless
Neurotic	Driven and frantic; easily rattled by failure or horror
Jealous	Resentful of anyone with better gear, status, or quarters
Greedy	Compelled to hoard; deeply unsatisfied without accumulating value
Hyper-Empathetic	Others' pain is your own; witnessing suffering distresses you deeply
Claustrophobic	Panics in confined spaces, narrow corridors, or underground
Body Modder	Driven to replace organic flesh with cybernetics and augments

Physical

TRAIT	DESCRIPTION
Wimp	Zero tolerance for pain; minor injuries cause breakdown
Slowpoke	Physically sluggish; last to react and last to escape
Trigger-Happy	Shoots fast and recklessly; a danger to anyone nearby
Careful Shooter	Takes far too long to aim; hesitates while chaos unfolds
Brawler	Distrusts ranged weapons; prefers to solve things up close
Sickly	First to catch infections or react badly to the environment
Klutz	Drops tools, trips, and disrupts at the worst moments

Habits

TRAIT	DESCRIPTION
Teetotaler	Refuses all substances, even when they could save lives
Absent-Minded	Forgets crucial details — locked doors, packed supplies, secured restraints
Loud	Booming voice and heavy footsteps; stealth is near impossible
Squeamish	Cannot handle blood or gore without nausea or fainting

Social

TRAIT	DESCRIPTION
Abrasive	Naturally rude and condescending; ruins negotiations and friendships
Stubborn	Won't admit being wrong or change course against all evidence
Misogynist/Misandrist	Deep contempt for one gender; openly disrespects and antagonizes them
Creepy Presence	Something grating about you; people naturally want distance
Kind	Puts others' well-being first; avoids cruelty even at personal cost
Ugly	Features others find unpleasant; tends to make poor first impressions
Beautiful	Strikingly attractive; charms easily but provokes jealousy and obsession

Traits Under Pressure

Traits are not background details. They are active — they define the choices a character makes when the stakes are real.

A Trait becomes a **Burden** when a situation directly targets it and the fiction demands a real cost. A **Volatile** character who holds it together demonstrates strength. One who doesn't — who snaps, escalates, puts someone in danger — generates a Narrative Point for the table.

TRAITS AS INVITATION

The most useful Traits are not the ones that never come up — they are the ones that surface at the worst possible moment and cost something real.

RUNNING THE OASIS

The Oasis is survival science fiction with a horror edge. The horror is consequential. The world didn't break because of monsters. It broke because of people, their choices, and an aftermath that outlives every choice made.

Your colonists are not heroes arriving to fix things. They are survivors trying to build something survivable in a world still paying for something they weren't there to witness.

The colony is a pressure system: food, power, morale, and security all degrade without maintenance. Let the players feel that weight every session.

The surface is an antagonist. Not a monster. Not a faction. The marsh grinds without intent. Sessions without encounters — just the marsh, the wrong sound, the missing team member, the thing that came back different — are sessions doing their job.

Reward investigation with information that hurts. The truth of this world is recoverable. It does not help.

WHAT PLAYERS KNOW AT SESSION ONE

The drive failed. The world collapsed while they slept. The surface is wrong in measurable ways. There are people out there who know things the colonists don't.

WHAT THEY WILL DISCOVER

Why the world ended. What the anomalies are. Whether the drive can be rebuilt. Whether the colony still wants to leave once it understands why it came back.

DIAPHRAGMA® CHARACTER MANIFEST

THE OASIS

IDENTITY

CHARACTER NAME

PRONOUNS

ROLE / PROFESSION

HIGH CONCEPT

STORY FLAGS

BEFORE CRYO

WHAT WAKING CHANGED

TROUBLE / CRACK

PROFICIE + PLAY

PROBLEM 1

☐ SCB
☐ SES

PROBLEM 2

☐ SCB
☐ SES

PLAY NAME

RELATIONSHIPS

1

Track the people who matter most.

TRAITS + BURDENS

TRAIT

circle(radius: 2.2mm

stroke

0.8pt

+

BURDEN FORM

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fill:

pale)

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BURDEN FORM

ink,

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WHEN IT MATTERS

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pale)

JOURNAL / PORTRAIT / SCENE NOTES

Use this for sketching the character, tracking evolving facts, drawing a location, or marking key discoveries.

KIT

3

ONLY WRITE GEAR THAT ACTUALLY MATTERS

NP

OPEN QUESTIONS